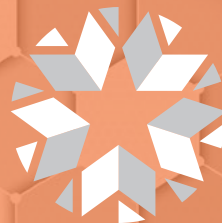


OKLAHOMA SCHOOL TESTING PROGRAM

TEST BLUEPRINT AND ITEM SPECIFICATIONS
GRADE 6 ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS



OKLAHOMA
Education

You will now read two related passages and answer the questions that follow. Some of these questions may ask you to compare the two passages.

The Pirate Queen

- 1 For generations, pirates have been the subjects of legends filled with peg legs, eye patches, and parrots. But there was once a very notorious pirate who is said to have broken every mold.
- 2 Grace O'Malley was born in Ireland in 1530 with a yearning for the sea. Her father was a sailor, just like his father before him, and she had seen him set sail many times. More than anything, Grace wanted to go with him. When her mother refused to let her go, saying that the sea was no place for young ladies, Grace angrily cut off her long hair in protest. Her family mocked her, nicknaming her "Grace the Bald."
- 3 In those days, young ladies were supposed to get married and have children, and Grace did just that. She and her husband, Donal O'Flaherty—a sea-goer himself—had two sons and a daughter. But being a wife and mother didn't suppress Grace's longing for the sea, and she soon took charge of her husband's fleet.
- 4 At that time, Ireland was falling under English rule. England was enforcing new restrictions, making it unlawful for the Irish to transport goods at sea—which took away the livelihoods of many Irish citizens. Grace believed this was unfair and refused to accept it. Whenever a merchant ship would pass by on its way to trade at the large port of Galway, Grace would sail out in one of her fastest galleys, intercept the ship, and demand that they pay a fee for safe passage. If they refused, she would signal her men to board the ship and take its cargo.
- 5 When her husband died, the law said that Grace was supposed to be given a portion of his property. However, women didn't have many rights back then, and the law was ignored. With no husband and no business, Grace decided to take several hundred faithful followers and set up her own pirate fortress on Clare Island, off the coast of Ireland. The island provided the perfect location from which to monitor the waters along the coast and continue to pirate passing merchant ships.
- 6 Grace wanted to control the entire island—and she did, except for one bothersome little section known as Rockfleet Castle, which was owned by a man named Dick Burke. In a clever business move, Grace arranged to marry Burke, with the agreement that after one year, they could end the marriage if they wanted. When the year was up, Grace is said to have shut herself up in the castle, refusing to come out and sending her husband away.

- 7 When Grace was in her sixties, her sons and brother were taken prisoner in England. Feisty as ever, Grace boldly set sail for England and visited the queen there, asking for their release. It must have been a sight to see: Grace the pirate, clothed in her finest, standing there among England's richly dressed ladies and gentlemen of the court.
- 8 But amazingly, the queen seemed to take a liking to Grace, and they became allies of sorts. The queen agreed to the release of Grace's family, and Grace agreed to fight for the queen's interests at sea.
- 9 Perhaps the Queen of England felt that Grace's skills at sea would serve England well. Or perhaps she recognized in Grace the rare spirit of independence that she herself possessed. Either way, Grace lived out the rest of her life sailing the seas, just as she had always wanted to.

"The Pirate Queen." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

Read this passage, which goes with the previous passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Grace O'Malley

- 1 Born in a castle close to the sea
In the long-ago year of 1530,
Was a fierce little babe named
Grace O'Malley.
- 5 A proper young lady she did not want to be
And she chopped off her hair so she could sail the high seas.
Grace learned to manage a great ship or two
And lead with great skill the unruly crew.
As a result of life's cruel fates
- 10 Grace moved with her people and built new gates.
She watched the sea with an eagle eye
Ships paid her taxes or did not go by.
Grace met with a queen dressed in her best
To save some family from early eternal rest.
- 15 The queen and Grace became friends
And remained so until their ends.

"Grace O'Malley." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

1

A student is creating a chart that identifies common elements of poetry. Complete the table by dragging two sentences into the table to correctly show common elements of poetry.

To drag a sentence, click and hold the sentence, and then drag it to the desired space. To change a sentence, click and hold it, and then drag it back to the original location.

It includes important dates.

It is organized using stanzas.

It has a problem and solution.

It has rhythm.

Common Elements of Poetry
It has rhyme.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

6.2.R.2: Students will analyze details in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts to distinguish genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student must identify the common elements of poetry from a list of possibilities.

Correct

Common Elements of Poetry
It has rhyme.
It has rhythm.
It is organized using stanzas.

Incorrect

Common Elements of Poetry
It has rhyme.
It includes important dates.
It has a problem and solution.

Distractor Rationale

The student is unsure of the common elements of poetry.

2 Why is “Grace O’Malley” considered poetry?

- A** It uses figurative language.
- B** It provides factual information.
- C** It uses a certain rhyme scheme.
- D** It is organized using sequential order.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

6.2.R.2: Students will analyze details in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts to distinguish genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student must identify the common elements of poetry from a list of possibilities.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Figurative language is not unique to poetry and may be found in other genres.
- B. Factual information may be found in certain types of fiction and nonfiction.
- C. **Correct.** Stanzas 3, 4, and 5 follow an AABB rhyme scheme—the first and second lines rhyme and the third and fourth lines rhyme.
- D. Fiction and nonfiction may also be organized sequentially.

3 Which detail from the passage best supports the author’s perspective that Grace O’Malley was a courageous leader?

- A** “When her mother refused to let her go, saying that the sea was no place for young ladies, Grace angrily cut off her long hair in protest.”
- B** “With no husband and no business, Grace decided to take several hundred faithful followers and set up her own pirate fortress on Clare Island, off the coast of Ireland.”
- C** “In a clever business move, Grace arranged to marry Burke, with the agreement that after one year, they could end the marriage if they wanted.”
- D** “Either way, Grace lived out the rest of her life sailing the seas, just as she had always wanted to.”

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

6.3.R.2: Students will evaluate how perspective (e.g., historical, cultural, ethnic, and global) affects a variety of literary and informational texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. The student needs to have a good understanding of the passage in order to know the author’s perspective and then needs to evaluate details from the passage to come to a conclusion.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This evidence might show that she was courageous to go up against her mother by cutting off her hair, but it does not show that she was a courageous leader.
- B. Correct. A person who will go out on her own without any resources to help her and establish her own fortress while being responsible for hundreds of others is an example of a courageous person.**
- C. This evidence does not demonstrate her courageous leadership abilities, just her business acuity.
- D. This does not show her courageous leadership abilities but does show a fulfillment of her lifelong dream.

4 In “The Pirate Queen,” how did the author **mainly** structure the information in the selection?

- A** by comparing O’Malley to other pirates of the time
- B** by organizing the events of O’Malley’s life in sequential order
- C** by describing the problems O’Malley faced as a female pirate
- D** by explaining what caused O’Malley to set up her own fortress

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

6.3.R.7: Students will analyze how informational text structures support the author’s purpose:

- compare/contrast
- cause/effect
- problem/solution
- description
- sequential

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This is a DOK 2 because the student needs a strong understanding of the passage in order to determine which organizational structure is used.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The passage does not detail a comparison of O’Malley to other pirates other than her station in life as a female, so this is not how the passage is structured overall.
- B. Correct. Since this is a biography about O’Malley’s life, the selection is organized with dates and transition words to provide a sequential order about her life.**
- C. The passage does infer some problems that O’Malley faced because she was a female, but this is not how the passage is structured overall.
- D. The passage does detail why O’Malley made the decision to set up her own pirate fortress, but this is not how the passage is structured overall.

- 5** Based on the information in **both** passages, explain why Grace O'Malley felt the need to rebel. Provide evidence from the passages to support your answer.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

6.3.R.8: Students will analyze one or more ideas from a text, providing textual evidence to support their inferences.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3. The response requires a deep understanding of the passage and of the character, Grace. The student makes near and far inferences using information from the passage and beyond to respond to the question.

Correct Response:

Score	Description
2	The response fulfills the requirements of the task by explaining why Grace O'Malley felt the need to rebel and includes relevant details from both passages to support the response.
1	The response fulfills the requirements of the task by providing an incomplete explanation about why Grace O'Malley felt the need to rebel, or the response provides incomplete or irrelevant evidence from the passages to support a valid explanation, or the response only include details from one passage.
0	The response does not fulfill the requirements of the task. The response is incorrect, irrelevant, or missing.
Blank	

Possible responses:

- Grace felt it was important to take direct actions against whomever or whatever she thought was being unfair.

Possible evidence for support:

She cut her hair off when her mother told her she could not go with her father because that was not ladylike behavior.

- “When her mother refused to let her go, saying that the sea was no place for young ladies, Grace angrily cut off her long hair in protest.” (paragraph 2)

She robbed the English merchant ships if they didn't pay a fee for safe passage because of the laws not allowing the Irish to transport goods at sea.

- “Whenever a merchant ship would pass by on its way to trade at the large port of Galway, Grace would sail out in one of her fastest galleys, intercept the ship, and demand that they pay a fee for safe passage. If they refused, she would signal her men to board the ship and take its cargo.” (paragraph 4)

She went to a remote island and set up her own pirate business because of the laws ignoring women's rights to own property.

- “With no husband and no business, Grace decided to take several hundred faithful followers and set up her own pirate fortress on Clare Island, off the coast of Ireland.” (paragraph 5)

When her sons and brothers were taken as prisoners to England, she went in person to ask the queen for their release.

- “Feisty as ever, Grace boldly set sail for England and visited the queen there, asking for their release.” (paragraph 7)

Other responses are acceptable if supported by relevant evidence from the text.

6 Based on information in paragraph 5 of “The Pirate Queen,” what does the word **unruly** mean in line 8 of the poem, “Grace O’Malley”?

- A** not able to measure
- B** not easy to control
- C** well behaved
- D** very friendly

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

6.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student uses information in a passage to determine the meaning of a word.

Distractor Rationale

- A. There is nothing being measured in paragraph 5. Further, the root word “ruly” is not related to measurement. It means “obedient” or “orderly.”
- B. Correct.** The information in paragraph 5 states that Grace and her followers “set up a pirate fortress,” and that they “...continu(ed) to pirate passing merchant ships.” Pirates are not known for their obedient behavior.
- C. Although “well behaved” fits in the poem, paragraph 5 does not suggest that the crew was “well behaved.”
- D. Although “very friendly” fits in the poem, paragraph 5 does not suggest that the crew was “very friendly.”

7 In “The Pirate Queen,” which meaning is the **best** definition of **intercept** as it is used in paragraph 4?

- A** to stop
- B** to race
- C** to enter
- D** to change

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

6.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must comprehend the text, particularly in paragraph 4 and make inferences in order to determine the meaning of a word.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** The word “intercept” in this paragraph means to prevent or stop someone or something from continuing to a destination.
- B. The word “intercept” in this paragraph does not mean to race.
- C. The word “intercept” in this paragraph does not mean to enter.
- D. The word “intercept” in this paragraph does not mean to change.

- 8** A student wants to use the poem “Grace O’Malley” in a paper. To cite this poem using MLA style, the student should use the following format: the author, title, source of the poem, publisher, publication date, and page number.

Which citation should the student use?

- A** “Grace O’Malley” by T.G. Terry. Published in *The Book of Irish Poems* written in 1985, pp 403.
- B** Terry, T. G. “Grace O’Malley.” *The Book of Irish Poems*, Lucent Publishers, 1985, pp. 403.
- C** *The Book of Irish Poems*, “Grace O’Malley,” Lucent Publishers, 1985, pp. 403.
- D** 1985, Terry, T.G. “Grace O’Malley. Lucent Publishers, pp. 403.

Standard 6: Students will synthesize information ethically through speaking and writing.

6.6.W.3: Students will quote findings following a consistent citation style (e.g., MLA, APA) to avoid plagiarism.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student is provided the necessary information for the citation in the stem and identifies a citation that contains the same information.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This choice is missing the name of the publisher; further, the elements are in the wrong order.
- B. Correct. This citation includes all the elements in the correct order needed for the poem “Grace O’Malley.”**
- C. This choice is missing the author of the poem, and the elements are in the wrong order.
- D. This choice is missing the source of the poem, and the elements are in the wrong order.

9 Which book would provide the most relevant information for a report about Grace O'Malley?

- A** *The Irish Economy from 1400–1650*
- B** *Women Sailors on the High Seas*
- C** *A History of English Royalty*
- D** *A Guide to Ships of the Past*

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

6.6.R.3: Students will determine the relevance and reliability of the information gathered.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3. The correct response requires that the student have a strong understanding of the information in the passage and use that information to make an inference about an external resource that will provide relevant information about a topic.

Distractor Rationale

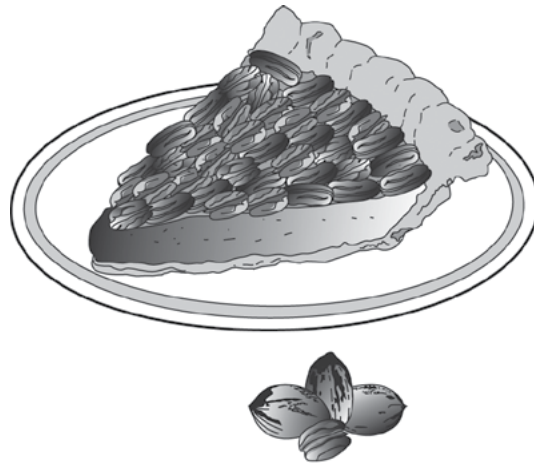
- A. Though O'Malley was Irish, a book about the Irish economy during the time she lived would not provide relevant information about O'Malley.
- B. Correct.** Since O'Malley was a female pirate, a book about women sailors would provide the most relevant information about O'Malley.
- C. A book about English royalty would not provide information about O'Malley because she was not royalty; she just encountered royalty.
- D. A book about ships would not provide relevant information about O'Malley.

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

The Okmulgee Pecan Festival

- 1 Every year something big happens in Okmulgee, Oklahoma. Thousands of guests flock to the town. How does this small place lure so many visitors? Simple. Each June they bake the world's biggest pecan pie. Then they invite everyone in the state to come enjoy a piece! The result is a fun time and full stomachs for everyone.
- 2 Okmulgee lies just off US Highway 75. It's a hop, skip, and a jump from Tulsa, and it's a short two-hour drive from Oklahoma City. Most of the time, Okmulgee is a quiet, little town. However, that changes each June when the Okmulgee Pecan Festival opens. It transforms the town into one of Oklahoma's most famous sites.
- 3 Although the festival has gone on for years as a local celebration, it didn't become famous until the late 1980s. In the early 1980s, Okmulgee held a friendly contest with a town in Georgia. The two towns competed to see who could make the largest pecan pie. They passed the title back and forth many times over the years.
- 4 Then in 1989, Okmulgee became serious about the competition. The town invited people from the local campus of Oklahoma State University to help. Together the town and the school's culinary (cooking) department claimed a big victory.
- 5 The winning pie measured nearly 42 feet across. That is about as long as a school bus. It weighed 14 tons. That's heavier than a full-grown African elephant! The list of ingredients included 77,700 cups of flour and more than 64,000 eggs. The main ingredient, of course, was more than 3,000 pounds of shelled pecans.
- 6 Since 1989, Okmulgee has claimed more pecan prizes. It now owns world records for largest pecan brownie, largest pecan cookie, and biggest pecan party. Its festival is famous throughout the state.
- 7 Kris Williams, who led the 2004 festival planning team, wants to keep it that way. "Our festival has long been one of the best in the state," he said. "We want to keep it one of the best."

- 8 To reach that goal, the planning team keeps adding to the festival. The festival now boasts more than the giant pie. Live music, arts and crafts booths, and a carnival are part of the annual event. There is surely something at the festival to satisfy everyone's craving!



"The Okmulgee Pecan Festival." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

10

A student is creating a paraphrase of paragraph 2. Drag two sentences into the appropriate boxes to complete the paraphrase.

To drag a sentence, click and hold the sentence, and then drag it to the desired space. To change a sentence, click and hold it, and then drag it back to

Generally, it is a peaceful town.

It is possible to get there in two hours.

In June, the Okmulgee Pecan Festival makes the city a popular place.

Many people enjoy eating pecans.

Okmulgee, located just off a major highway, is close to two large cities.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

6.2.R.3: Students will paraphrase a paragraph in their own words to demonstrate comprehension.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to comprehend the text and rephrase it while maintaining fidelity to the text.

Correct

Okmulgee, located just off a major highway, is close to two large cities.
Generally, it is a peaceful town.
In June, the Okmulgee Pecan Festival makes the city a popular place.

Incorrect

Okmulgee, located just off a major highway, is close to two large cities.
It is possible to get there in two hours.
Many people enjoy eating pecans.

Distractor Rationale

The incorrect answer contains information that is not in the specific paragraph.

11 Read a student's paraphrase of paragraph 2.

Okmulgee, located just off a major highway, is close to two large cities. Generally, it is a peaceful town.

Which sentence **best** completes the paraphrase?

- A** In June, the Okmulgee Pecan Festival makes the city a popular place.
- B** There are many tourists during the summer.
- C** The Okmulgee Pecan Festival is in June.
- D** Many people enjoy eating pecans.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

6.2.R.3: Students will paraphrase a paragraph in their own words to demonstrate comprehension.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to comprehend the text and rephrase it while maintaining fidelity to the text.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** This sentence logically follows the preceding sentence and includes the necessary information to form a paraphrase.
- B.** This information is not contained in paragraph 2.
- C.** While this sentence contains relevant information, it is incomplete.
- D.** This information is not contained in paragraph 2.

12 Which detail would be the least important to include in a summary of this passage?

- A** Kris Williams led the planning team in 2004.
- B** Each year, thousands of tourists visit Okmulgee for the pecan festival.
- C** Since 1989, the pecan festival has claimed other prizes for Okmulgee.
- D** The Okmulgee Pecan Festival is held each year during the month of June.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

6.2.R.1: Students will summarize alphabetic and/or multimodal texts, including main idea, to demonstrate comprehension.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. The response requires comprehension of the passage in order to determine relevant main ideas and details. The student uses that knowledge to evaluate presented details to make a choice.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** Who led the team in 2004 is not an important detail to include in a summary about this festival and what makes it unusual.
- B.** This detail is important because it provides the reader with the enormity of the attendance at the festival.
- C.** This detail is important because it provides the length of time that the festival has been receiving prizes.
- D.** This detail is important because it provides the time of year the festival is available.

13 What is the main idea of paragraphs 6 through 8?

- A** The Okmulgee Pecan Festival has been held since 1989 and owns world records for the largest pastries ever baked.
- B** The Okmulgee Pecan Festival appeals to a wide audience because there are many different activities.
- C** The Okmulgee Pecan Festival has a reputation for being an outstanding festival because of constant efforts by the planning teams.
- D** The Okmulgee Pecan Festival planning team meets every year to make sure the festival continues to be the best in the state.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

6.2.R.1: Students will summarize alphabetic and/or multimodal texts, including main idea, to demonstrate comprehension.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must draw meaning from the passage, and paragraphs 6 through 8 in particular, to determine the main idea.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is a detail from these paragraphs, not the main idea.
- B. This is a detail from these paragraphs, not the main idea.
- C. Correct. This statement provides the main idea of paragraphs 6–8 as they detail the festival's accomplishments and the commitment of the planning committee.**
- D. This is a detail from these paragraphs, not the main idea.

14 Which fact from the passage best supports the argument that the Okmulgee Pecan Festival is one of the best in the state?

- A** The result is a fun time and full stomachs for everyone.
- B** Together the town and the school's culinary (cooking) department claimed a big victory.
- C** That's heavier than a full-grown African elephant!
- D** It now owns world records for largest pecan brownie, largest pecan cookie, and biggest pecan party.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

6.3.R.6: Students will categorize facts included in an argument as for or against an issue.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to have a clear understanding of the passage in order to determine which detail supports an argument.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This claim does not support the argument that this festival is the best in the state.
- B. This claim does not support the argument that this festival is the best in the state.
- C. This claim does not support the argument that this festival is the best in the state.
- D. **Correct.** Winning world records supports that the festival must be one of the best in the state.

15 How does the author structure paragraphs 3 through 6 of this passage?

- A** by giving a brief history of the pecan festival
- B** by comparing the pecan festival to other festivals
- C** by describing how problems with the festival were solved
- D** by explaining step-by-step how the festival was organized

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

6.3.R.7: Students will analyze how informational text structures support the author's purpose:

- compare/contrast
- cause/effect
- problem/solution
- description
- sequential

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to have a strong understanding of paragraphs 3 through 6 in order to make a determination about how they are organized.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** Paragraphs 3–6 provide historical context for when the festival began and how it has progressed over the years.
- B.** There are no other festivals discussed in these paragraphs.
- C.** No issues were introduced in these paragraphs that needed to be solved.
- D.** These paragraphs do not describe how the festival was organized.

- 16** In paragraph 7, Kris Williams states that, “Our festival has long been one of the best in the state.” Explain what type of organized evidence the author could add to support that claim. Provide details from the passage to support your answer.

Standard 3: Students will thoughtfully and intentionally write, addressing a range of modes, purposes, and audiences.

6.3.R.7: Students will analyze how informational text structures support the author’s purpose:

- compare/contrast
- cause/effect
- problem/solution
- description
- sequential

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because the student must analyze the passage to determine what additional information from outside the passage could help the author support a particular claim.

Scoring:

Rubric

Score	Description
2	The response fulfills the requirements of the task by explaining evidence the author could add to support that claim and provides more than one detail from the passage to support the answer. The information provided is based on the text and is relevant to the task.
1	The response fulfills some requirements of the task, but some of the information may lack specificity or is not supported by the text.
0	The response does not fulfill the requirements of the task. The response is incorrect, irrelevant, or missing.
Blank	no response

Sample Response

Possible responses include:

A chart, graph, or data point showing how the number of attendees has increased over time.

“Thousands of guests flock to the town.” (paragraph 1)

A chart showing the types and numbers of awards the festival has been awarded.

“Since 1989, Okmulgee has claimed more pecan prizes.” (Paragraph 6)

A list of specific musicians, arts and crafts booths, and carnival rides or attractions.

“Live music, arts and crafts booths, and a carnival are part of the annual event.” (Paragraph 8)

Other responses are acceptable if supported by relevant evidence.

17 Which sentence uses title the same way it is used in paragraph 3?

- A** What is the title of your favorite book?
- B** My school won the district basketball title.
- C** A car's title document lists the official owner.
- D** She was given the title of Assistant Manager.

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

6.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. The response requires the student to determine the meaning and usage of a word and apply that knowledge to respond to the question.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The definition of "title" in this sentence is the name of a written piece of work.
- B. Correct. The definition of "title" in this sentence and paragraph 3 is a contest held to determine a championship.**
- C. The definition of "title" in this sentence is a legal document that shows ownership.
- D. The definition of "title" in this sentence is a special designation given to a person.

A student wrote a report on the famous performer Will Rogers. Read the first part of the report, think about what suggestions you would make, and then answer the questions.

The Life of Will Rogers—Part 1

1 In the early 1920s, people needed something to make them smile. The events of
2 World War I remained fresh in American minds, and many people had suffered
3 through illness during a terrible flu epidemic. To make matters worse, people was
4 worried about their jobs. Into this gloomy picture rode Will Rogers. Rogers did
5 more than just make people smile; he made them laugh out loud. His charm and
6 humor made him Americas' favorite cowboy.

7 William Penn Adair Rogers was born in Oklahoma in 1879. Rogers was not sure
8 what kind of career he wanted. He decided not to make a decision right away.
9 Instead, Rogers spent his early adult years traveling to different places and
10 working different jobs. In 1902, he traveled to South Africa where he trained
11 horses for the British Army. He also performed as a trick roper in "Texas Jack's
12 Wild West Circus." He called hissself the "Cherokee Kid" for this show.

"The Life of Will Rogers—Part 1." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

18 How should the two sentences in lines 1 through 3 be rewritten to form a compound sentence?

- A** The events of World War I remained fresh in American minds, many people had suffered through illness during a terrible flu epidemic.
- B** The events of World War I remained fresh in American minds or many people had suffered through illness during a terrible flu epidemic.
- C** The events of World War I remained fresh in American minds. And many people had suffered through illness during a terrible flu epidemic.
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

6.5.W.1: Students will compose simple, compound, and complex sentences to add clarity and variety in their writing.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. It requires the student to recall what a compound sentence is and use that information to make a revision to an existing sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. By inserting a comma between these two sentences without including a coordinating conjunction, this becomes a comma splice, a type of run-on sentence, not a compound sentence.
- B. By inserting the coordinating conjunction “or” between these two sentences, the meaning of the sentence changes and a compound sentence has not been formed.
- C. Beginning the second sentence with the conjunction “And” makes the second sentence a clause that cannot stand by itself, and a compound sentence has not been formed.
- D. Correct. The use of the coordinating conjunction “and” preceded by a comma correctly combines the two sentences into a compound sentence.**

19 What change, if any, should be made to the verb was worried in lines 3 and 4?

- A** are worried
- B** am worried
- C** were worried
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

6.5.R.2: Students will recognize and explain the impact on meaning of parts of speech in sentences:

- nouns
- verb tense to signify various times, sequences,
- subject and verb agreement
- adjectives
- prepositional phrases
- reflexive pronouns and their antecedents
- singular they/them/their
- subordinating conjunctions
- adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This is a DOK 1 because the student applies knowledge about subject-verb agreement.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Because the subject “people” is plural and the sentence is in the past tense, the use of “are” is incorrect.
- B. Because the subject “people” is plural and the sentence is in the past tense, the use of “am” is incorrect.
- C. Correct. For correct subject and verb agreement, the auxiliary “were” is the correct form to use with the past tense verb “worried” to agree with the plural subject “people.”**
- D. Because the subject “people” is plural and the sentence is in the past tense, the use of “was” is incorrect.

20 What change, if any, should be made to Americas' in line 6?

- A** Americas
- B** America's
- C** Americas's
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

6.5.R.6: Students will write using correct apostrophe mechanics. *Grade of Mastery: 5*

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This is a DOK 1 because the student applies knowledge about possessives.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The proper singular noun "America" needs to be possessive and requires an apostrophe before the "s."
- B. Correct. The proper singular noun "America" needs to be possessive and requires an apostrophe before the "s."**
- C. This form is incorrect because the proper singular noun "America" needs to be possessive and requires an apostrophe before the "s," not an additional "s."
- D. This would be correct if the proper noun was plural, but it is singular, so the apostrophe and "s" must come after "America."

21 What change, if any, should be made to hissself in line 12?

- A** his
- B** him
- C** himself
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

6.5.R.2: Students will recognize and explain the impact on meaning of parts of speech in sentences:

- nouns
- verb tense to signify various times, sequences,
- subject and verb agreement
- adjectives
- prepositional phrases
- reflexive pronouns and their antecedents
- singular they/them/their
- subordinating conjunctions
- adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This is a DOK 1 because the student applies knowledge about reflexive pronouns.

Distractor Rationale

- A. “His” is a possessive pronoun, not a reflexive pronoun.
- B. “Him” is an objective pronoun, not a reflexive pronoun.
- C. **Correct. “Himself” is a reflexive pronoun.**
- D. “Hissself” is an incorrect example of a reflexive pronoun.

Read the next part of the report, think about what suggestions you would make, and then answer the questions.

The Life of Will Rogers—Part 2

13 Rogers continued performing as a trick roper even after he returned to the United
14 States. For nearly ten years, he traveled with the Wirth Brothers Circus. Then, in
15 1915, he received a lucky offer. Legendary showman Florenz Ziegfeld asked
16 Rogers to appear in one of his stage shows. The show was called the Ziegfeld
17 Follies. The appearance was supposed to last only one week, but Rogers was a big
18 hit with the crowds. Ziegfeld asked him to stay with the show, he continued
19 performing in the follies. Rogers performed in the follies for several months.
20 Rogers did excellent rope tricks, but he was more popular for his humor than his
21 roping. Rogers realized that performing in the follies was different from doing
22 tricks for the circus. The circus traveled from town to town. Even when it played
23 the same town for several days different people watched the shows. This meant
24 Rogers could perform it over and over again.

"The Life of Will Rogers—Part 2." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

22 What change, if any, should be made to the sentences in lines 18–19?

- A** Ziegfeld asked him to stay. With the show, he continued performing in the follies for several months.
- B** Ziegfeld asked him to stay with the show, and he continued performing in the follies for several months.
- C** Ziegfeld asked him, to stay with the show, continue performing in the follies, and perform in the follies for several months.
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

6.5.W.3: Students will recognize and correct the following: run-ons, errors in subject and verb agreement, inappropriate shifts in verb tense, and inappropriate shifts in pronoun number and person.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. The student needs to evaluate the sentence to determine its error and make a correction.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The prepositional phrase “with the show” has been misplaced from the phrase “to stay,” which it is actually modifying.
- B. Correct. This sentence corrects the run-on and redundant sentence by combining the ideas into a compound sentence.**
- C. This sentence has issues with the parallel structure of the verbs.
- D. This sentence structure has a run-on and redundant sentence.

23 What change, if any, should be made to days different in line 23?

- A** days, different
- B** days: different
- C** days; different
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

6.5.W.7: Students will use commas to separate an introductory element from the rest of the sentence and to indicate direct address (e.g., Where are you, Sam?).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1. The response requires the student to apply the rules surrounding punctuation in complex sentences.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct. Because this is a complex sentence, a comma is the correct punctuation for separating the introductory dependent clause from the independent clause.**
- B. Because this is a complex sentence with the dependent clause appearing first, a comma is needed, not a colon.
- C. Because this is a complex sentence with the dependent clause appearing first, a comma is needed, not a semicolon.
- D. Because this is a complex sentence with the dependent clause appearing first, a comma is needed to separate the two clauses to avoid a run-on sentence.